

CONNIE XIE

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GitHub: <https://github.com/conxie>

Portfolio: <https://conxie.github.io>

EDUCATION

University of California, San Diego (UCSD), La Jolla, CA
B.S., *Clinical Psychology, with Distinction in Honors*

Sep 2021 – June 2025
cGPA: 3.99 / 4.00

- Advisor: Dr. Dawn Schiehser
- Honors Thesis: *Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease*

B.S., Cognitive Science with a Specialization in Cognitive Behavioral Neuroscience
Summa Cum Laude

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Neurocognition and Movement Lab Research Assistant
| VA San Diego Healthcare

March 2024 - Present

Advisor: Dawn Schiehser, Professor of Psychiatry

- Administration and scoring of neuropsychology tests (WMS-IV, CVLT-II, DOT-A, CWIT, DKEFS Verbal Fluency, JLOT-O, BNT-15) and assisted with fMRI scans to learn more about the effects of mild to moderate Traumatic Brain Injury (TBI) on Parkinson's disease (PD).
- Developed an Advanced Auto-Diagnosis Script for Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection.
- Backcoded UPDRS Part 3 Imputation Calculator for dataset cleaning.
- Managed data cleaning and preprocessing for three large-scale longitudinal research datasets.

Kiyonaga Lab Research Assistant

| UC San Diego Department of Cognitive Science

Sep 2023 - Present

Advisors: Anastasia Kiyonaga, Professor of Cognitive Science, Yueying Dong, PhD candidate

- Leading independent research on the Pupillary Near Response in Visual Working Memory (WM) tasks.
- Conducted eye tracking experiments in using Eyelink to study the activity of feature-specific information of the internally-prioritized WM content.
- 30+ presentations in Journal Club about how to utilize novel research in working memory, gaze, and pupillometry.
- 4+ coding projects to understand Pupil Processing Pipeline in Python.

CDC Community Liaison

| UC San Diego Department of Global Health

Sep 2023 - Feb 2024

Advisor: Mor Shilon, Professor of Urban Planning

- Interviewed 300+ residents of Logan Heights and the Logan Heights CDC to assess priorities for allocating state funding towards community issues through in-person interviews.
- Assisted in the production of a community film, art show, and awareness campaign.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 101: Developmental Psychology		Sep - Dec 2023
	Professor: Gail Heyman • Led 10+ weekly, midterm, and final review sessions. Conducted personalized one-on-one sessions with 10+ students who were unable to attend live lectures. • Received unanimous student recommendations in course feedback surveys in the upper-division course.		
	Undergraduate Instructional Assistant UC San Diego PSYC 102: Sensory Neuroscience		Sep - Dec 2024
	Professor: Nirelia Morantron • Held weekly office hours and 5 exam review sessions for 200 students. • Delivered a 1.5 hour lecture on the Anatomy of the Ear and Audition.		
MENTORSHIP	UC San Diego 		
	• Mira Mateo, <i>Undergraduate Student</i> • German Lopez, <i>Transfer Student</i> • Soobin Jones, <i>Honors Student</i>	2024 – Present	2024 – Present
PUBLICATIONS			2024 – 25
	1. Xie, C., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Progression of Cognitive Decline in Individuals with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025. 2. Dong, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A. Testing the Flexibility of Pupillary Working Memory Signals to Visual and Semantic Task Demands. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025. 3. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Manuscript in Prep</i>, 2025 4. Xie, C., Mao, Y., Park, A., Geller, E. Memory and Emotion: How Prior Emotional Facial Expressions Affect Our First Impression of Niceness. <i>Journal of Undergraduate Psychological Research</i>, 2024.		
POSTERS			
	1. Xie, C. Chen, E., Adler, J., Carillo, A., Lin, A., Longardner, K., Schiehser, D. Cognitive Diagnostic Categorization of Parkinson's Disease patients with and without Traumatic Brain Injury. <i>Presidential Poster presentation at American Geriatrics Society</i>, 2025. 2. Dong, Y., Hung, Y., Xie, C., Kiyonaga, A., Brady, T. Testing the Flexibility of Pupillary Working Memory Signals to Visual and Semantic Task Demands. <i>Vision Sciences Society</i>, 2025. 3. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Submitted for Society for Neuroscience</i>, 2025 4. Xie, C., Geller, E. Relationships Between Sexual Orientation, State Political Affiliation, and Sex Drive. <i>Honors Poster Session</i>, 2024.		
PROFESSIONAL TALKS			
	1. Xie, C., Gitelman, D., Adler, J., Schiehser, D. Automated Mild Cognitive Impairment Detection (PD-MCIx) in patients with Parkinson's Disease. <i>Undergraduate Research Conference</i>, 2025 2. Adler, J., Xie, C., Schiehser, D. TBI+: The Interplay of TBI and Neurodegenerative Disease. <i>Center of Excellence for Stress and Mental Health</i>, 2025		

OTHER PROJECTS	1. Xie, C., Ganis and Kievit Mental Rotation Replication Study. <i>GitHub Repository</i> , 2024.	
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	• Student Member, International Parkinson and Movement Disorder Society • Student Member, American Geriatric Society • Student Member, Society for Neuroscience	
SKILLS	Programming: R, SPSS, Python, JavaScript, HTML, MATLAB Libraries and Apps: PANDAS, Tidyverse, Haven, dplyr, ggplot2, MICE Psychophysics: Eye-Tracking Software (Eyelink), Psychopy, jsPsych Imaging Tools: Functional Magnetic Resonance Imaging (fMRI), Electroencephalogram (EEG) Assessment: BNT-15, D-KEFS, WAIS-IV, WMS-III, MDRS, DOT-A, CVLT-II, JLOT-O, CWIT Languages: English, Cantonese, Mandarin Miscellaneous: RedCAP, Soldering, Adobe Photoshop, Arduino, Advanced Statistical Methods	
AWARDS	• Distinguished Undergraduate Researcher Award, UC San Diego • Phi Beta Kappa • Anderson Research Travel Award • Thurgood Marshall Travel Award • Provost Honors, UC San Diego	2025 2025 2025 2024 2021-2025